

Agent Selection & Commission Negotiation Checklist — Northern Territory

Choosing the right agent, and understanding what you're actually agreeing to.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice.

Section 1 — Shortlisting Agents

- ☐ [] **Interview at least 3 agents** and compare their recent comparable sales in your specific Darwin, Alice Springs, Palmerston, or regional NT area.
- ☐ [] **Ask for a genuine appraisal, not just the highest number** — cross-check against real recent comparable sales.
- ☐ [] **Ask how they'll market the property** and get this in writing.
- ☐ [] **Check their recent track record for your specific property type.**
- ☐ [] **Ask directly about any referral relationships** with conveyancers, stylists, or other service providers, and whether they receive a fee for those recommendations.

Section 2 — Understanding the Agency Agreement

- ☐ [] **Understand this is a legally binding contract** — read every clause, not just the commission rate.
- ☐ [] **Confirm the commission rate is negotiable** — it isn't fixed or regulated at a set percentage.
- ☐ [] **Clarify exclusive vs. open listing terms** and how long any exclusive period runs.
- ☐ [] **Check marketing cost responsibility** — confirm upfront whether costs are included in commission or charged separately, in writing.

Section 3 — Understand Your Buyer Pool's Financial Position

- ☐ [] **Understand many prospective buyers may qualify for the HomeGrown Territory Grant** (\$50,000 for new homes) or the House and Land Package Exemption, which meaningfully expands buyer budgets for new or house-and-land purchases — relevant to how your agent positions and prices a new-build listing.
- ☐ [] **Discuss with your agent how the NT's grant-based (rather than duty-exemption-based) buyer support affects your specific property's marketing**, particularly if it's new construction versus an established home.

Section 4 — Choosing Your Method of Sale

- ☐ [] **Compare auction vs. private treaty for your specific property and market conditions.**
- ☐ [] **Discuss the NT's flexible cooling-off arrangements with your agent** — since the standard 4-business-day period can be varied by agreement, understand how your agent typically structures this for buyer negotiations.

Section 5 — Before You Sign

- ☐ [] **Have a solicitor review the agency agreement** if you're at all uncertain.
- ☐ [] **Clarify the termination process** — what happens if you want to change agents partway through the listing period.
- ☐ [] **Confirm who's preparing your contract and disclosure documents**, and organise this in parallel with appointing your agent.
- ☐ [] **Ask for references from recent vendors**, not just buyer testimonials.

Quick Reference — Key NT Agent Agreements

ITEM	DETAIL
Commission rates	Not fixed/regulated — negotiable
Buyer grants (new homes)	HomeGrown Grant (\$50,000) or HLPE duty waiver may apply — relevant to marketing
Cooling-off period	4 business days, generally no penalty, can be varied by agreement

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